

is well over \$100,000 higher than it would have been if we had been making car payments all this time!

Throughout our lifetimes, this one decision will be worth well over \$1 million and likely multiple millions! Just by driving perfectly lovely yet older cars. Think about how powerful that is. Some more extreme—and maybe gross—examples come from Bobby Hoyt of *Millennial Money Man* and Carl of *1500 Days to Freedom*. Bobby talked of his love of boating and Carl of travel when they came on the *ChooseFI* podcast. Both men publicly “bragged” that their wives made them throw away underwear and socks with holes in them. They’re not too poor to afford new underwear, nor are they too cheap to buy it. It’s just not a priority to go shopping, so they don’t bother. I’m not proud to admit my wife had to give me the same talk.

Being a valuer is pretty simple when you understand it. Be happy with simple things. Budget or track your spending so you know where your dollars are going. Align your spending with the things that are truly important to you.

Action Steps